

Transcutaneous Pacing

Transcutaneous pacing is an important procedure performed by EMS to improve perfusion to vital organs.

Indications for transcutaneous pacing

- Symptomatic bradycardia
- Third degree heart block

Contraindications

- Asystole
- PEA cardiac arrest

Relative Contraindication

- Bradycardia due to hyperkalemia

Equipment needed

- Cardiac monitor
- Pacer pads
- Consider procedural sedation (Ketamine) or pain management

Transcutaneous Pacing

1. Prepare equipment
 - a. Place pacer pads over
 - i. Anterior/Posterior is preferred
 - ii. Anterior below right clavicle and left lower chest is secondary placement
 - iii. Avoid placement over AICD or transdermal drug patches
2. Activate Pacing Mode – Turn on the monitor and select the pacing mode
3. Connect cables to the monitor
4. Set the pacing rate to 70 bpm
5. Increase current output by 10 mA until pacing rate captured on monitor
6. If pacing rate is not captured at current of 120-130 mA – place pacer pads in alternate location and repeat steps above
7. Once pacing captured, set current at 5-10 mA above the threshold